

bandwidth, and that will keep your bills in check. Some software will also let you set maximum speeds per client, or cut-off points to stop Net access when a user reaches A prescribed bandwidth limit.

Of course, software that offer all of the above or more will cost a bundle, or will they?

PROXYPLUS (PROXY+)

Proxy+ is proxy software that has both free and paid versions. The free version allows for three users (two concurrent) to use the proxy. The two-concurrent-user restriction means only two people can be using the proxy at the same time. The licensing price for five users is \$99 (about Rs 3,950), for 10 users is \$199 (Rs 7,900), and for unlimited users is \$299 (Rs 11,950). You can get the latest version from www.proxyplus.net.

Installing

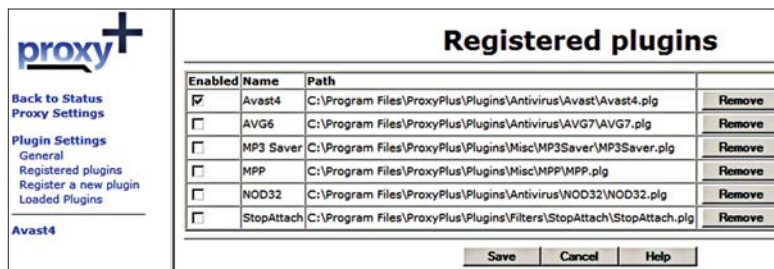
This is as simple as can be. Just download the software and double-click it. The last step in the setup process is important, and you should tick the "Install as a Windows service" to run the proxy in the background as a service.

Configuring

Proxy+ can be configured by using a browser and navigating to <http://localhost:4400> from the same computer or http://<Your_IP>:4400 from another computer on the LAN.

Once you get to the Proxy+ Admin page, you can start setting up your proxy server. Everything is explained, and help is available in detail from Start > Programs > Proxy+ > Guide, or online at www.proxyplus.net/doc/en/proxyguide.htm.

In order to allow your networked computers to use Proxy+, you need to inform them to change the settings in their Web browsers. In Internet Explorer, you'll need to go to Tools > Internet Options > Connections. Here, if you have an account name in "Dial-Up settings", select Never dial a connection.



Anti-virus plugins for Proxy+

Then press LAN Settings... Uncheck Automatically detect settings and Use automatic configuration script. Select Use a proxy server and fill the IP address of the PC running Proxy+ in the Address field, and set the Port to 4480. Instructions for other browsers are at the page mentioned.

IMPORTANT CONFIG SETTINGS

Almost everything you see when configuring is self explanatory, but we will list significant settings here to ensure you set up your proxy right:

Using Proxy+, you can choose to only dial a connection when someone on the network tries to access a site or use a protocol

Add users

At the Proxy+ Admin page, click on Accounts at the left and then on Users. Type in the name of at least one user, say Admin, add a password, and click Add. This will make sure that you have at least one user for the next step. You can come back later and add all the users you wish.

Change Admin Access

By default, Proxy+ configurations can be changed by anyone who navigates to http://<Your_IP>:4400 from any computer on your LAN. This is open to exploit, so you should change this ASAP. After making a user and setting a password, click on Administrator and then General at the left. Check the WWW Admin requires authentication box, select the user from the drop-down, and click Save. This will force anyone who browses to http://<Your_IP>:4400 to enter a username and password to go any further.

Restarting

Proxy+ requires a restart after all major settings changes. This is because the software reads settings when it starts up—so don't be alarmed when you make changes and don't see the results immediately. In order to restart Proxy+, just go to Administrator > Restart, and click Restart. In a few seconds the page will be refreshed and your new settings will take effect.

Changing Ports

By default, Admin access is at port 4400; browsers need to set port 4480 to use the proxy, and if you set more proxies such as FTP gateways, the port is 4421, etc. All this can be changed, and you can choose custom ports, say 1337 (geek for "elite") for admin and normal proxy ports, such as 8080, or others like 12345, etc., for the services. Just go to Proxies > General, and you will see all the settings listed on the right. Change these values to what you desire, and remember to click Save and also restart Proxy+ for the changes to take effect.

Dialup

If you are on dialup, or even broadband dialup (PPPoE), you don't want to leave it connected all the time. Using Proxy+, you can choose to only dial a connection when someone on the network tries to access a site or use a protocol. You can even choose which protocols activate dialling. Just go to Dialing > General and select your connection—Proxy+ will identify and list all available connections you have here automatically—and click Save. To choose the protocols that activate auto-dialling, go to Dialing > Auto Dial, check the boxes for the protocols that can initiate an Internet connection, and click Save. We recommend you set this to only HTTP and FTP.

Setting Mail Accounts

This is a very useful feature in Proxy+, and it enables you to set the proxy server to download mails from POP3-enabled accounts. This results in a much faster experience for users, because when they download their e-mail into their